



CASE STUDY #12

Torch-it

Venture Name



OVERVIEW

1. Brief Background of the Case Study
2. Issue/s generated by the Case Study
3. Main body: Discussion of the Case
4. Conclusion

1. BRIEF BACKGROUND OF THE CASE STUDY

CASE STUDY BACKGROUND

Torch-It was founded by Hunny Bhanchandani, an industrial engineering graduate from Pandit Deendayal Petroleum University, Gandhinagar. During his internship at the Blind People's Association in Gujarat in 2013-14, Hunny witnessed a life-changing incident: a visually impaired person was involved in a serious accident due to a malfunctioning assistive device. This experience made him realize the urgent need for better, more reliable assistive technology for the visually impaired.

This incident motivated Hunny to design a better solution for the visually impaired. After creating a prototype, he received positive feedback from users and showcased it with the help of his professor.

The government awarded him a grant of INR 25,00,000 (USD 33,000), allowing him to further develop his idea, which led to the founding of Torch-It. Since then, Hunny and his team have been working to create affordable and effective assistive devices for the visually impaired.



2. ISSUES GENERATED BY THE CASE STUDY

ISSUE/S GENERATED BY THE CASE STUDY (OCCURRENCES)

1. **Funding Challenges:** Securing investment is challenging, especially post-COVID-19, hindering expansion and product development.
2. **Revenue Dependence:** Reliance on specific partnerships and grants creates financial instability, making Torchit vulnerable to funding changes.
3. **Increased Competition:** An influx of competitors in the assistive technology market requires Torchit to differentiate its offerings to maintain market share.
4. **User Training Requirements:** Providing adequate training and support for users is resource-intensive and essential for ensuring product effectiveness.

3. MAIN BODY

DISCUSSION OF THE CASE

MAIN BODY– DISCUSSION OF THE CASE

Torchit was formally launched in 2017, Torchit aims to empower persons with disabilities (PwD) through innovative assistive technologies that promote independence and dignity. Leveraging AI and machine learning, Torchit creates user-centric products that address the specific needs of the PwD community.

Torchit has garnered over 50 awards, including national recognition from the President of India, underscoring its commitment to innovation. Its approach, which involves PwD in all aspects of production and feedback, empowers the community and fosters sustainability.

Torchit's product line includes several innovative assistive devices designed to meet various needs:

1. **Saarthi** (Smart Cane): This affordable navigation device offers high obstacle detection accuracy, enabling visually impaired users to navigate safely and independently.
2. **Able** (eBraille): A revolutionary tool that supports education and employment for the visually impaired, facilitating easy access to digital content.
3. **Flexmo** (Smart Crutches): Designed for users with lower body impairments, these crutches enhance mobility and comfort.
4. **Handicare**: An assistive device that improves indoor mobility for those with lower limb disabilities.
5. **VOIS** (Smart Gloves): This device aids communication for the hearing and speech impaired by converting spoken words into text.

MAIN BODY– DISCUSSION OF THE CASE

Market Landscape

The global market for assistive aids is vast, with over 1 billion people currently needing assistance, a number projected to grow to 2 billion by 2030. The majority of these individuals come from developing regions and lower-middle-income backgrounds, emphasizing the urgent need for affordable assistive technologies. Torchit's focus on this underserved market positions it to make a significant social impact while also tapping into a substantial business opportunity.

Revenue Growth and Strategy

Despite facing challenges during the COVID-19 pandemic, which affected initial revenue projections, Torchit has shown resilience and adaptability. The company has developed multiple revenue streams, including direct sales to end-users, partnerships with NGOs, and online sales. With a confirmed order book of INR 13.5 Crore for FY 21-22, Torchit aims to significantly increase its revenues in the coming years through strategic growth initiatives.

The execution strategy involves expanding production capabilities by outsourcing manufacturing while maintaining quality control in-house. This strategy allows Torchit to scale up efficiently without the heavy capital investment typically required for manufacturing facilities.

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activity, deadline
or milestone here

MAIN BODY– DISCUSSION OF THE CASE

Marketing and Future Growth

Torchit plans to enhance its marketing strategy to build brand awareness and attract new customers, particularly in international markets. This includes increasing marketing budgets and exploring partnerships with NGOs, corporate sponsors, and government bodies to expand outreach.

The company aims to leverage digital platforms for e-commerce and online sales, making products more accessible to a broader audience. Additionally, Torchit intends to deepen relationships with existing partners while seeking new collaborations to drive larger projects and initiatives.

For future growth, Torchit is investing in research and development to innovate and improve existing products. This focus on continual improvement will help address evolving user needs and maintain a competitive edge in the assistive technology market. By diversifying its product offerings and targeting emerging markets, Torchit seeks to increase its impact and revenue significantly in the coming years.

4. CONCLUSION

LEARNING

CONCLUSION (LEARNING)

In the conclusion, Torchit has successfully positioned itself as an important player in the assistive technology market. By specifically focusing on the needs of visually impaired individuals, the company has created innovative products that significantly enhance their independence and daily lives. Torchit's user-friendly designs not only make it easier for users to navigate their surroundings, but they also foster a strong sense of loyalty among customers who appreciate the thoughtful solutions provided.

Additionally, Torchit has formed valuable partnerships with NGOs and government programs, which has helped to expand its reach and ensure that more people can access their products.

Overall, Torchit serves as a prime example of how a socially responsible business can achieve both financial success and a meaningful impact in the community, paving the way for a more accessible world for everyone.





END OF CASE QUESTIONS

End of case questions

1. Describe the Torch-It business
2. Can you identify the Business Model?
3. Estimate the TAM- total addressable market
4. Analyze the other players in the market
5. What are the sales achieved since FY 20 and the projections on the next year?
6. What are the key learnings from the Sales Strategy?
7. How does Torch-it plan to achieve the sales number?
8. What is the customer acquisition strategy pursuant and marketing activity?
9. For Torch-it, calculate the following 3 metrics and comment on the ratios
 - CAC
 - LTV
 - Churn rate
10. What were some of strategies that Torch-it adopted for Operational excellence while targeting scale?

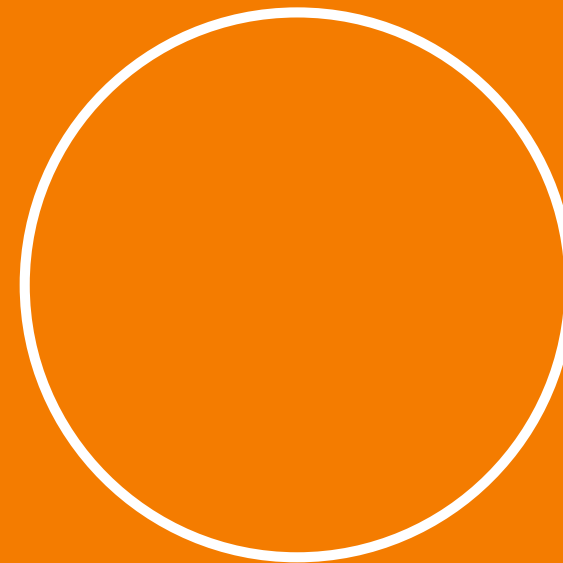
TEAM



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